

1.4 Safe Camp

1.4.2 Talking with Bnalth

Bnalth sits next to Elcryni, his eyes weary and tired. If the party approaches him, he will talk to them and answer their questions:

Who are you?

"My name is Bnalth, and this is Elcryni, my pupil. We are explorers, and I am teaching the girl my trade"

What are you doing here?

"We were sent to explore those seas for the queen. We hoped to map those islands and learn more about their resources."

Are there more people from the expedition?

"There were also Pilar and Tsalar, but we were separated. They were talking about lost treasures, naive fools..."

Why are you camping here?

"Elcryni got sick when we were sailing. We hoped to find some help on this island, but the Reshi cast us out, worried about us spreading some plague."

Roleplaying Bnalth

Characteristics: Fatherly, protective.

Goal: Take care of Elcryni.

Appearance: Bnalth (he/him) is a Thaylen man with his eyebrows tied with the rest of his long, black hair.

Bnalth is an expedition leader from Thaylenah. As a babsk of Elcryni, he treats her like his own daughter. Now, when she is sick, he is determined to do whatever is best for her.

1.4.3 Healing Elcryni

Characters may wish to attempt healing Elcryni. Doing so requires DC 18 Medicine check, but the check has disadvantage if players don't have healing herbs from the island. Failure does not improve the girl's state in any way. Success does little, too - the girl smiles faintly, but does not wake up.

If a player attempts using Stormlight in the attempt to heal her, other NPCs in the camp rush to stop them. If the player continues, spawn **Ravenous Larkin** draining the Investiture and failing the healing attempt.

It is important for Elcryni not to wake up. Her treatment is a part of the future plot. You can reward players for healing attempts in other ways, eg. with a warm thanks from Bnalth, but do not allow the girl to wake up.

Path to Radiance

Attempting to heal Elcryni may attract a cultivationspren.

1.4.4 Playing with Axehounds

There are at least 3 **Herdazian Axehounds** in the camp: Brightness, Joy and Dible. After atmosphere calms down and the party spends some time in the camp, they can invite PCs to play.

Brightness is a well-groomed, pretty female **Herdazian Axehound** with a gleaming carapace and a red ribbon bow tied around her antennae. She is visibly worried about Elcryni - she lies by her side, never leaving, with her eyes staring at the sick girl all the time.

Dible is a very friendly male **Herdazian Axehound** who wears a green collar. He likes to approach strangers to ask for scratches. When you pet him, he is making a purr-like clicking sound with his mandibles, earning him the name.

Joy is the youngest of the pack, not much older than a pup. He loves to play and walks around the camp with his stuffed blue skyeel toy. When a character is nearby, he drops the toy onto their feet, asking to throw it. When he dashes to fetch it, he always jumps happy once he catches his toy back, often attracting a joyspren or two.

There are two reasons to have cute axehounds in the camp: to offer some counterbalance after the tense fight and to make players love them. Or at least - get attached to them.

Each time the party comes back to the camp, spare a moment to have axehounds compete for players' attention, happy to see them again. The more fun the party has with them, the more devastating will be the loss of them in the later chapters.